

August 21, 2026

Editors

The R Journal

Dear Editors,

Please consider our article, “statnnet: Regression-Style Statistical Summaries for Neural Networks Fitted with `nnet`”, for publication in *The R Journal*.

The article presents the `statnnet` package, which augments a deliberately restricted class of fitted `nnet` models with statistical information that is not supplied by the fitting package itself. The package reconstructs the fitted objective and curvature, reports individual- and covariate-level Wald summaries, distinguishes observed-row predictive finite differences from partial-dependence contrasts, supplies pointwise uncertainty intervals, and provides diagnostic, plotting, and prediction methods through a familiar R modelling interface.

We believe the article is relevant to R Journal readers because `nnet` remains a widely used and stable R implementation of shallow neural networks, while its standard output is primarily directed toward fitting and prediction. The contribution of `statnnet` is intentionally narrower than a general neural- network interpretation framework: it uses the exact parameter ordering, objective, Hessian, convergence information, and fitted object produced by `nnet`. The article places this contribution in context with model-agnostic tools and with `NeuralNetTools`, `NeuralSens`, and `cito`, and states clearly where their estimands and inferential mechanisms differ.

The manuscript and its examples are fully reproducible from the supplied R Markdown source, scripts, and package data. The package source, tests, documentation, and development history are maintained publicly at <https://github.com/andrew-mcinerney/statnnet>. We understand that an R Journal package submission requires CRAN availability and will submit this manuscript only after the corresponding `statnnet` release has been accepted on CRAN.

This manuscript is original, has not been published previously, and is not under consideration by another journal. Both authors have approved its submission.

Yours sincerely,

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